
							3.2 - requirement numbering	SET-UP: Your section 3.2 groups requirements into five modules, exactly as the structure asks. But no individual requirement has a number. Section 3.2.3 is one single bullet that does three things: it merges lab results with clinical records, it detects unlinked records, and it quarantines them. QUESTION: Split that one bullet into separate numbered requirements, and then tell me what your team loses by having no requirement numbers anywhere in this document.

Splits it into three atomic requirements, each numbered in the 3.2.3.n style the handout asks for, each a single 'The system shall' statement with something a tester could check - for example, merge using subject, visit and aliquot identifiers; flag any record with no match; move flagged records to quarantine and notify the data manager. On what is lost: no way to cite a requirement in a review, no mapping from requirement to design to test case, no change control, and no verification matrix. Strong answers notice that most of their requirements are written as feature bullets ('Maintain a register', 'Check expected columns') rather than 'shall' statements.

							3.3 - performance targets	SET-UP: Section 3.3 says upload acknowledgement should take 'less than 2 to 5 seconds' and search should return 'in less than 3 to 5 seconds'. Section 3.5 says the platform handles files up to 2 GB across ten or more instruments at once. QUESTION: In each of those ranges, which number is the actual requirement? And how long is a 2 GB file allowed to take from upload to a validated, released dataset?

Recognises that a range is not a target: if a response takes 4 seconds, nobody can say whether it passed. Picks one figure per requirement and adds the conditions - a percentile, a defined load, a measurement point. On the second half, concedes that nothing in the document bounds validation, linkage or harmonisation time, which is the platform's main job, and proposes a real requirement such as 95% of 2 GB files validated within a stated number of minutes. Strong answers add the missing throughput and concurrency figures and tie them to the ten-instrument claim in 3.5.

							2.5, 3.4.2, 3.5 - de-identification	SET-UP: Three parts of your document say different things about patient identifiers. Section 2.5 assumes the laboratory hands you data that is already de-identified. Section 3.4.2 requires de-identification before ingestion but does not say who does it. Section 3.5 says the system separates direct identifiers into secure key vaults, which only makes sense if the system is holding identifiers. QUESTION: Does your platform ever receive a participant's direct identifiers - yes or no - and which requirement in section 3.2 actually performs the de-identification?

Recognises the three statements cannot all be true and picks a position rather than improvising a reconciliation. If data arrives de-identified, the key vault in 3.5 is wrong and must be removed, and the assumption in 2.5 must become a hard constraint on the source. If the platform de-identifies, then a functional requirement is missing entirely and the ethics and approval implications change. Either way should explain how linkage by subject and visit identifier still works with a pseudonymised key, and say who holds the key map. Strong answers note that this is exactly the kind of question an ethics committee asks first.

							2.4 vs 3.4 - duplicated constraints	SET-UP: Raw file immutability, role-based access control, AES-256 and TLS 1.3, scalability, usability, backups, configuration-over-code and LIMS integration all appear twice in your document - once in section 2.4 and again in section 3.4 - in almost the same words. Some appear a third time in section 3.5. QUESTION: If someone changes the encryption requirement in one of those sections and forgets the others, which copy is the real requirement? And what should 2.4 and 3.4 each contain so this cannot happen?

Identifies duplication as a maintenance hazard rather than a formatting preference: copies drift apart the moment one is edited, and a reader cannot tell which binds. States the correct division of labour - 2.4 General Constraints describes constraints imposed on the project from outside at overview level, 3.4 holds the single authoritative, detailed statement, and 3.5 states the measurable attribute - then proposes deleting the duplicates and cross-referencing instead. Strong answers spot the third copy in 3.5 and point out that a document about single sources of truth should practise one.

							Diagrams - absent throughout	SET-UP: Your acronym list in section 1.3 defines DFD, Data Flow Diagram. There is no data flow diagram in this document. There is also no context diagram, no architecture diagram and no use-case diagram - the entire submission is text and tables. QUESTION: Draw the context diagram for this platform on the board - the platform itself, the external systems around it and the user classes - and then tell me what a diagram shows that your written description of the five pillars cannot.

Draws the platform as one box with the external entities around it: laboratory instruments, REDCap/EDC, the existing LIMS, the identity provider, object storage, BI tools and the notification service, with the four operational user classes attached. Explains that a diagram forces boundary decisions that prose can leave vague - and points at their own unresolved LIMS relationship in 2.1 as the example, because a diagram cannot show 'to be clarified later'. Strong answers note that defining an acronym they never used is itself evidence of a section that was planned and never written.

							1.2 and 2.1 - scope boundary	SET-UP: Section 2.1 says the relationship with the existing LIMS - whether your platform integrates with it, complements it, or replaces parts of it - will be clarified later during a discovery phase. Section 1.2 has no out-of-scope list at all. QUESTION: Your developers start work next month and need to know what to build for the LIMS. What do you tell them, and what would you put in an out-of-scope list to protect this project from work it never agreed to do?

Recognises that an SRS is a baseline, so an undecided boundary means the work cannot be estimated, scheduled or accepted, and that 'to be clarified during discovery' is acceptable in a charter but not in a specification. Proposes either a decision now or an explicit, dated assumption with a named owner and a change-control route if it proves wrong. Then drafts a real out-of-scope list: no replacement of LIMS functions, no instrument control, no clinical data capture, no statistical analysis or modelling, no long-term archival beyond a stated period. Strong answers note that both other groups wrote an out-of-scope list and this document did not.

							Document control and the contents page	SET-UP: This document specifies semantic version numbers, immutable records and tamper-evident audit logs for other people's data. The document itself has no version number, no date, no author list, no approver and no revision history. On top of that, your contents page lists a section 2.2.6 Access and Analytics that is not in the document, section 3.4.3 is in the document but not on the contents page, and section 1.5 promises an 'other requirements' section that was never written. QUESTION: What should this document's own front matter contain, and what single review

Lists the front matter: version number, date, status, authors, reviewer and approver, and a revision history table recording what changed and why - and connects it directly to the versioning discipline the document demands of everyone else. On the review step: a final consistency pass by one named editor, regenerating the contents page from the body and checking every forward reference, before submission. Strong answers apply their own section 3.2.4 semantic versioning scheme to the document and note that seven authors writing in parallel need one owner to merge.